

- Avoid taking a call while crossing the road, as your attention could be diverted, and you may stray into the path of oncoming traffic—stand on the pavement if you receive a call.
- Always buy a cell phone that's SAR-approved. This ensures that the radiations emitted are minimal.

The Future of the Cell Phones



Five years ago, mobile phones were only for the wealthy, who could afford their fat price tags. However, now there seem to be more mobile phones than households in metro cities of India, and the numbers are growing. We have already approached the time when it will be considered unusual not to have a mobile phone. Projections suggest that the majority of voice calls will be mobile-to-mobile in the near future, due to low tariffs. Fixed lines will mostly be used for data connections.

All this depends, of course on pricing. GPRS is booming on various service providers, and the cost of calling a mobile phone from a fixed phone is becoming expensive. SMS text messaging—and now MMS—have become the communication medium of choice for many in their teens and twenties, despite the relatively high cost. In fact, this is the only really new form of communication to have emerged in decades.



Mobile phones are evolving fast. Today's latest handset model is new for just a few weeks, and obsolete in a few months. And network technologies are moving just as fast.

We can soon see 'third generation' (3G) frequency networks that will offer much faster data access and more capacity. It's likely that this trend will displace many fixed-line phones. However, the huge price paid for the licenses suggests that these facilities won't come cheap.

Another interesting thing that one might see soon in the mobile phone market is disposable cell phones. Randi Altschul from New Jersey will soon provide the world with her unique concept of disposable cell phones. The phone will be extremely small (about the thickness of three credit cards) and extremely lightweight. Better still is the price; the phones are expected to sell for under \$20, which will include 60 prepaid minutes of calling time.

This Phone Card Phone can make outgoing calls only; the consumer will be able to add phone minutes with their credit or debit cards until the non-replaceable battery dies. A large part of this phone will be made out of paper products that can be colourfully printed with images and advertisements, which would make them great give-away items for company promotions.

